Federico del Gaudio

Combat & Technical Designer

CONTACTS

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My Linkedin

My Portfolio

SUMMARY

Combat & Technical Designer with a strong foundation in Unreal Engine (Blueprints) and Unity. My design process starts with a question: **why** does this combat feel good? I break down reference games, isolate the mechanics, then **prototype** answers in Unreal Engine 5. That curiosity is what drives every system I build.

HARD SKILLS

Unreal Engine 5
- Blueprints & Visual Scripting
- Animation Blueprints & State Machines
- Hitbox & Physical Animations
- Behavior Trees & AI

Unity
- C#

Dev Tools
- Git / GitHub / Fork
- Visual Studio, VS Code
- Confluence

DESIGN SKILLS

- **Combat design**
  - Enemy AI archetypes & Behavior Trees
  - Combo systems
  - Melee / ranged mechanics
  - Hitbox & Hurtbox Implementation
- **Data-Driven Balancing**
  - TTK tuning, difficulty scaling
  - Playtest analysis & iteration
- **Prototyping in Engine**
- **Technical Documentation**
  - AI behaviors, weapon systems, abilities

LANGUAGES

- Italian (Native)
- English (C1 Professional)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Adrias Online
February - March 2023, Rimini RN
- Role: **Front-end Developer**
  - Contributed to front-end layout adjustments and image optimization for a **live** client website, improving load performance.
  - **Collaborated** with the development team to debug and resolve compatibility issues across browsers and devices.

EDUCATION

2024 - 2026 Expected Graduation
Digital Bros Game Academy
Game Design Course

2019 - 2024 Graduated
ITTS "O. Belluzzi L. da Vinci"
High school Diploma - Computer science 72/100

PROJECTS

One Night In Venice
(UE5 itch.io Game jam | Solo Project — January 2026)

A tight, roguelite-inspired bullet hell shooter.

- **Designed & scripted** 4 distinct enemy AI archetypes and a multi-phase boss fight, tuning global TTK and implementing combat juice (hit-stop, screen shake, dynamic VFX).
- **Built a data-driven** progression system using UE5 Data Tables, increasing playtest replayability.
- **Developed dynamic** difficulty scaling to manage enemy spawns and stats, sustaining an optimal 35-minute average session length.

Patch Me If You Can
(Unity FPS Project | Team of 11 — May-July 2025)

A **fast-paced** first-person shooter where you play as a voodoo tailor hunting your runaway creations.

- **Designed** and **iterated** on harpoon shooting mechanics, improving responsiveness, readability and player feedback.
- **Managed** balancing metrics for **3** enemy AI classes, utilizing data across 4 dedicated playtest sessions to fine-tune encounter difficulty.
- **Analyzed** data and player feedback from 3 official playtests to fine-tune gameplay mechanics, improving overall pacing and game feel.

Pummel
(UE5 Combat Prototype | Solo Project — April-June 2024)

A 2.5D action game with combo-based melee combat against magical enemies.

- **Developed a 3-hit** and aerial combo system fully driven by Animation Blueprints and State Machines, structuring transition logic to ensure fluid player agency and precise timing windows.
- **Implemented** dynamic hitbox/hurtbox registration linked to Animation State Machines to ensure frame-accurate combat collision and precise timing windows.